

■ B.1.2 Symbols

Symbols are the basic named objects in *Mathematica*.

The name of a symbol can be any sequence of letters and digits, not starting with a digit. Symbol names can also contain the character \$. Upper and lower case letters are always distinguished in *Mathematica*.

aaaaa	user-defined symbol
Aaaaa	system-defined symbol
\$Aaaa	internal system-defined symbol

Symbol naming conventions.

It is a convention that the names of system-defined symbols usually consist of one or more complete English words. The first letter of each word is capitalized, and the words are run together.

Mathematica uses the ASCII international character set. Characters with decimal codes between 160 and 255 are treated as alphabetic, and can thus appear in symbol names.